



Q

What is the recommended storage temperature for frozen fruits and vegetables to maintain quality?



ANSWER

0°F (-18°C) or below

FUN FACT

Using a freezer thermometer can help maintain safe and optimal freezing conditions.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables



Q

Why is blanching important before freezing most vegetables?



ANSWER

It inactivates enzymes that cause loss of color, flavor, and texture

FUN FACT

Blanching times vary by vegetable type, so precise times are important.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables



Q

Which of the following foods does NOT freeze well due to texture changes?



ANSWER

Lettuce

FUN FACT

Freezing causes lettuce to become limp and watery upon thawing.

Source: SP 50-766 Foods that do not freeze well



Q

What is one effective way to reduce freezer burn on frozen seafood?



ANSWER

Exclude as much air as possible from the package

FUN FACT

Freezer burn causes dehydration and off-flavors in seafood.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Q

When freezing seafood in jars, how much headspace should you allow for ice expansion?



ANSWER

At least one-half inch

FUN FACT

Allowing proper headspace prevents glass jars from breaking due to ice expansion.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Q

Why is vacuum packaging recommended before freezing seafood?



ANSWER

It reduces oxidation and freezer burn

FUN FACT

Vacuum packaging slows quality loss during frozen storage.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Q

How long can most fruits and vegetables maintain high quality in the freezer at 0°F?



ANSWER

8 to 12 months

FUN FACT

Unsweetened fruits tend to lose quality faster than those packed in sugar.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables



Q

What is a safe practice regarding refreezing thawed fruits and vegetables?



ANSWER

Refreeze only if foods still contain ice crystals and are 40°F or below

FUN FACT

Refreezing food warmed above 40°F can pose food safety risks.

Source: PNW 214 Freezing fruits and vegetables



Q

What does freezer burn do to frozen foods?



ANSWER

Dries out food and toughens texture

FUN FACT

Freezer burn is caused by moisture loss and air exposure.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Q

How should you freeze small portions of seafood for convenience and quality?



ANSWER

Wrap individually in cling plastic wrap and place in a heavy-duty freezer bag

FUN FACT

Smaller portions can be thawed separately and more quickly.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Q

What is the recommended relative humidity condition in a root cellar for storing root vegetables?



ANSWER

High humidity, typically around 90-95%

FUN FACT

High humidity prevents produce from shriveling during storage.

Source: OSU winter crop storage guide



Q

Why should onions and garlic be stored separately from other vegetables in cold storage?



ANSWER

They release odors that can flavor other vegetables

FUN FACT

Proper separation helps maintain the flavor quality of stored crops.

Source: OSU winter crop storage guide



Q

How long is it safe and best quality to store cheddar-type cheese in a home freezer?



ANSWER

6 to 12 months

FUN FACT

Freezing cheese can slightly alter texture but keeps it safe when stored properly.

Source: SP 50-711 Frozen food storage guide



Q

What is the recommended maximum storage time for cottage cheese in the freezer?



ANSWER

1 to 2 weeks

FUN FACT

Cottage cheese does not freeze well for long periods due to texture changes.

Source: SP 50-711 Frozen food storage guide



Q

What is a sign that frozen seafood has experienced freezer burn?



ANSWER

Off flavor, color change, and dry tough texture

FUN FACT

Freezer burn reduces quality but does not make food unsafe to eat.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Q

What happens to ice crystals in frozen food during freezer temperature cycling?



ANSWER

**Ice crystals grow larger,
damaging texture and quality**

FUN FACT

*Keeping freezer temperature stable
helps maintain food quality longer.*

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Q

How should you label frozen food packages for best inventory management?



ANSWER

**Date, contents, form,
approximate weight, and
servings**

FUN FACT

*Proper labeling prevents unnecessary
freezer door openings and waste.*

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Q

How does storing foods tightly packed in the freezer affect freezing speed and quality?



ANSWER

It speeds freezing and reduces ice crystal size, preserving quality

FUN FACT

Air pockets act as insulation and slow the freezing process.

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Q

Why must glass jars used for freezing be only partially filled?



ANSWER

**To allow for water expansion
and prevent jar breakage**

FUN FACT

*Water expands about 10% when it
freezes into ice.*

Source: PNW 586 Home freezing seafood



Q

Why is it important not to alter tested home freezing recipes?



ANSWER

Changing ingredients or procedures can affect safety and quality

FUN FACT

Tested recipes balance acidity, freezing times, and preparation steps for safe preservation.

Source: OSU Extension MFP